MS EXCEL · UNIT 4

Saving, Copy, Cut and Paste

Save · Open · Undo and Redo · Copy, cut and paste · Drag

4	4	10	1
Topics	Practices	Shortcuts	Practice file

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Saving a workbook

4.1 · Theory

FIRST SAVE — 5 STEPS

1. **Press Ctrl + S**
   Excel opens the Save As screen the first time.
2. **Choose a folder**
   For example Documents → Browse. Pick a place you can find again.
3. **Type a file name**
   Short and clear, such as StudentMarks. Avoid / \ : * ? " < > |
4. **Keep the file type**
   Excel Workbook (*.xlsx).
5. **Click Save**
   The Title Bar now shows your file name.

Save

`Ctrl + S`

Saves your changes to the same file. After the first save it does not ask again.

Save As

`F12`

Saves a copy with a new name, place or type (File → Save As). The first file stays as it was.

Save early and save often — Ctrl + S takes one second.

Practice 4.1: Save a workbook

Practice · 1 of 4

GOAL

Save a new workbook, change it, then save a copy.

1. Type `Name` in `A1` and `Score` in `B1`.
2. Type `Ahmed` in `A2` and `80` in `B2`.
3. Press `Ctrl+S`. Choose a folder. Name it `MyFirstFile`. Click Save.
4. Check the Title Bar. Change `B2` to `85`.
5. Press `Ctrl+S` again.
6. Press `F12`. Name it `MyFirstFile2`. Click Save.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- The Title Bar shows MyFirstFile
- The second Ctrl+S did not ask for a name
- The Title Bar now shows MyFirstFile2
- You have two files: the original and a copy

Opening, closing, Undo and Redo

4.2 · Theory

Task	How	Shortcut
Open a file	File → Open → choose a file, or pick one from the Recent list	`Ctrl + O`
Close the workbook	File → Close — Excel itself stays open	`Ctrl + W`
Undo	Click the Undo arrow on the Quick Access Toolbar	`Ctrl + Z`
Redo	Click the Redo arrow — brings back what you undid	`Ctrl + Y`
Exit Excel	Click the X at the top-right of the window	`Alt + F4`

IF YOU CLOSE WITH UNSAVED CHANGES, EXCEL ASKS "DO YOU WANT TO SAVE?"

Save

Keeps your changes in the file.

Don't Save

Throws the changes away.

Cancel

Goes back to the workbook — nothing closes.

Practice 4.2: Open, Undo and Redo

Practice · 2 of 4

GOAL

Close a saved file, open it again, then undo and redo.

1. Type `Hello` in `A1`. Press Enter.
2. Press `Ctrl+S`. Name it `OpenTest`. Click Save.
3. Press `Ctrl+W` to close the workbook.
4. Press `Ctrl+O`. Click `OpenTest` in the Recent list.
5. Type `World` in `A2`. Press Enter. Press `Ctrl+Z`.
6. Press `Ctrl+Y`.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- OpenTest opens with Hello in A1
- Ctrl+Z removes World
- Ctrl+Y brings World back
- Closing a saved file shows no warning

Copy, cut and paste

4.3 · Theory

Copy

`Ctrl + C`

Makes a copy. The original stays where it is. You can paste as many times as you like.

Cut

`Ctrl + X`

Takes the data out and moves it. The original disappears when you paste.

Paste

`Ctrl + V`

Puts the copied or cut cells at the cell you click.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Select the cells
2. Click Copy or Cut
3. Click the first cell where it goes
4. Click Paste

GOOD TO KNOW

The buttons are in Home → Clipboard group. A moving dotted border shows the cells are copied — press Esc to clear it. Pasting over cells replaces what was there; press Ctrl + Z if you paste in the wrong place.

Practice 4.3: Copy, cut and paste

Practice · 3 of 4

GOAL

Copy names, move them, then use the Home tab buttons.

1. Type **Ahmed Ali**, **Sara Khan**, **Bilal Raza** in **A1:A3**.
2. Select **A1:A3**. Press **Ctrl+C**. Click **C1**. Press **Ctrl+V**. Press **Esc**.
3. Select **C1:C3**. Press **Ctrl+X**. Click **E1**. Press **Ctrl+V**.
4. Select **A1:A3**. On the Home tab click **Copy**.
5. Click **G1**. Click **Paste**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Copy: the names stay in A and appear in C
- Cut: C is empty — the names moved to E
- The Home tab buttons do the same job
- Names end up in columns A, E and G

Move and copy with the mouse

4.4 · Theory

To…	How	What happens
Move cells	Select them → point at the border until the pointer shows four arrows → drag	The cells move. Nothing is left behind.
Copy cells	Hold Ctrl while you drag the border (a small + appears)	The original stays and a copy lands where you drop it.
Copy down or across	Select the cell → drag the fill handle (the small green square at the bottom-right corner)	The same value is copied into each cell you drag over.

GOOD TO KNOW

The fill handle copies one value here. It can also continue patterns like 1, 2, 3 or Monday, Tuesday — you will learn that in the AutoFill chapter.

Practice 4.4: Drag to move and copy

Practice · 4 of 4

GOAL

Copy a value with the fill handle, then move and copy with the mouse.

1. Type **Present** in **A1**.
2. Drag the fill handle from **A1** down to **A5**.
3. Type **Ahmed Ali** in **C1**.
4. Point at the border of **C1** until you see four arrows. Drag it to **E1**.
5. Hold **Ctrl**. Drag the border of **E1** to **G1**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- A1:A5 all say Present
- C1 is empty — the name moved to E1
- E1 and G1 both show Ahmed Ali
- A small + appears while you hold Ctrl

Chapter 4 shortcuts

Summary · Theory

Shortcut	What it does	Shortcut	What it does
`Ctrl + S`	Save	`Ctrl + Z`	Undo
`F12`	Save As	`Ctrl + Y`	Redo
`Ctrl + O`	Open a file	`Ctrl + C`	Copy
`Ctrl + W`	Close the workbook	`Ctrl + X`	Cut
`Alt + F4`	Exit Excel	`Ctrl + V`	Paste

TIP

Learn these keys — you will use them in every chapter from now on. Ctrl + S is the one to press most often.

Unit 4 — Key takeaways

4.1	Save with Ctrl + S. Save As (F12) makes a copy. Use a short, clear file name and keep the .xlsx type.
4.2	Open with Ctrl + O, close with Ctrl + W. Undo is Ctrl + Z; Redo is Ctrl + Y.
4.3	Copy leaves the original; Cut moves it. Click the first cell of the destination, then Paste.
4.4	Drag the border to move, Ctrl + drag to copy. The fill handle copies a value down or across.